



sion of the CCUS infrastructure.

In this phase, in which ONGC aims to reach net zero operations for Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions. These are direct and indirect greenhouse gas emissions. For this, it has set a baseline of 9 MTCO₂e (million tonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent) reported in FY22.

Ratnesh Kumar, Executive Director of ONGC, says this is not a portfolio diversification exercise. "It is the deliberate construction

of an integrated energy company for the next 25 years. For me, the central idea is simple: ONGC must remain reliable, responsible and forward-looking. Energy security and sustainability are the same goal, viewed across two different timeframes," he says.

In this sustainability push, it is pulling out all stops to reduce emissions in every part of its operations. For instance, its leak detection and repair programme that has been

running since 2008 has helped detect and arrest fugitive methane emissions of 1.47 MTCO₂e.

"We monitor atmospheric methane across 166 ONGC locations using satellite data, and ground surveys are prioritised based on this intelligence," says Kumar.

In terms of renewable energy capacity, ONGC has set up an interim target of 10 GW by 2030. Two recent acquisitions are important anchors in this regard: ONGPL, a 50:50 joint venture with NTPC Green Energy, acquired Ayana Renewable Power, adding approximately 4.1 GW of renewable assets, with ONGC's share at around 2.05 GW. ONGC Green also acquired PTC Energy, which has 288 MW of operational wind capacity across Andhra Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh and Karnataka.

"We are also strengthening technology partnerships. Our MoU with BHEL covers the green hydrogen value chain, while our MoU with Tata Power Renewable Energy focuses on Battery Energy Storage Systems. We are developing compressed biogas plants at Hazira and Ankleshwar, evaluating Small Modular Reactors, discussing pumped storage with NHPC, and advancing CCUS in Gujarat," Kumar adds. **41**

ONGC is spearheading India's first geothermal energy development through ONGC Energy Centre in Ladakh. This project aims to harvest heat directly from the Earth to generate power.

"For ONGC, innovation is not confined to laboratories. It happens on rigs, in wells in Ladakh, in satellite operation rooms and in village panchayats. That breadth is what makes ONGC the energy company India needs," he signs off. **BT**

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